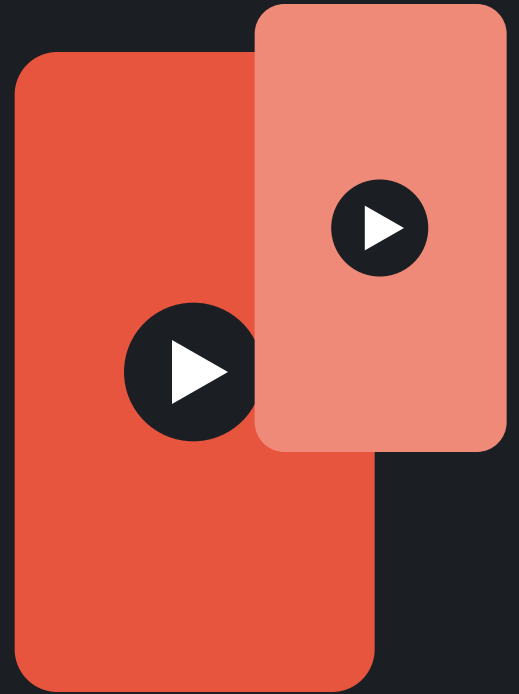




FACELESS SHORTS PLAYBOOK

30 Shorts in 30 days. No face, no gear, free apps only.

5 FORMATS | 60 HOOKS | 30-DAY CALENDAR | FREE-TOOLS WORKFLOW

What's inside

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Bonus files included with this download: hook_bank.csv and 30_day_calendar.csv. Import them into Google Sheets or Notion (File > Import) to tick off each day.

PART 1

Start here

This playbook gives you one system: pick a niche, use five faceless formats, open every video with a tested hook, edit in under 30 minutes with free apps, post daily for 30 days, and review once a week.

Read it once in about 45 minutes. Then keep three pages open while you work: the hook bank, the 30-day calendar and the batch-day checklist.

An honest note before you start. Most new Shorts channels get very few views in the first weeks, and most people who post short-form video earn little or nothing from it. Views and money depend on your niche, your consistency and platform rules that change often. What this playbook does is get you posting consistently with videos that are built correctly, which is the part most people never get past.

Your 30-day promise to yourself

Niche: _____ Start date: _____

Time I'll post every day: _____ Batch day each week: _____

PART 2

Pick your niche

Your niche is the topic you'll post about for the next 90 days. The right niche is one you can make 90 videos about without running out of ideas, and one where viewers can act on what you show them (buy a tool, try a recipe, save money). Score each idea from 1 to 5 on each question below. Pick the highest total. A tie goes to the one you'd enjoy more.

Question	Idea A	Idea B	Idea C
Niche idea			
Can I list 30 video ideas for this in 15 minutes?			
Do I already know more about it than a beginner?			
Are there products, apps or services people buy in this niche?			
Do faceless channels in this niche get views? (search it on Shorts and TikTok)			
Would I still be making these videos in month three?			
Total (out of 25)			

My niche, in one sentence: "I post about _____ for _____ who want _____."

Write 10 video ideas now:

The 5 faceless formats

Rotate these five formats. Each needs nothing more than a phone, free apps and, at most, your hands on camera.

1. List / countdown

What it is	On-screen text counts through 3 to 5 items over stock footage, screenshots or simple graphics.
Why it works	Viewers stay to see the last item. Lists are easy to script and easy to batch.
Structure	Hook (0-2s) > item 1 > item 2 > item 3 > best item last > call to action.
Example	"3 free apps that replace ones you pay for. Number 3 saved me \$120 a year."

2. Screen-record tutorial

What it is	Record your phone or computer screen while you show how to do one specific task.
Why it works	It's useful, so people save and share it, and saves tell the platform to push the video.
Structure	Show the result first (0-2s) > the steps, sped up > the result again > call to action.
Example	"Turn this iPhone setting on and your battery lasts longer." Then record yourself doing it.

3. Text-story over B-roll

What it is	A short story told entirely in on-screen text, over calm footage such as driving, cooking or city scenes.
Why it works	People read to the end to find out what happened, which raises watch time.
Structure	Tension in line one > 3 to 5 lines of story > a twist or lesson > a question for comments.
Example	"My boss said I'd never get promoted. Six months later..."

4. Voiceover explainer

What it is	You narrate a short explanation over stock clips, screenshots or simple animations. Your voice, not your face.
Why it works	A voice builds trust faster than text, and you can make a lot of these from one research session.
Structure	Bold claim (0-3s) > why it's true > one example > what to do about it.
Example	"The 50/30/20 rule, explained in 30 seconds."

5. Hands-only demo

What it is	Film only your hands doing something: cooking, unboxing, writing, building, cleaning.
Why it works	It feels real, it's satisfying to watch, and you never show your face.
Structure	Finished result (0-1s) > the process in quick cuts > the result again > call to action.
Example	"A \$6 dinner that feeds four." Overhead shot of your hands cooking.

Hooks: the formula and 60 templates

Viewers decide in the first two or three seconds whether to keep watching. The hook is the most important line you'll write.

The formula: [Specific number or result] + [who it's for or what it stops] + [a reason to stay]. For example: "3 apps (number) that replace ones you pay for (result). Number 3 saved me \$120 a year (reason to stay)."

- **Say the payoff in the first two seconds.** Promise one specific result and deliver it.
- **Put the hook on screen as text too.** Many people scroll with the sound off.
- **Start mid-action.** Cut every "hey guys", logo and slow intro.
- **Be specific.** "3 apps" beats "some apps" and "\$120 a year" beats "money".
- **Keep the promise.** A hook the video doesn't deliver loses viewers and trust.

Swap the [brackets] for your own details. Templates from other niches often work in yours too.

#	Money hooks
1	Stop doing [habit] if you want to save \$[amount] this year.
2	3 money rules I wish I knew at [age].
3	The subscription you forgot you're paying for.
4	I tracked every dollar for 30 days. Here's where it went.
5	One habit that quietly keeps people broke.
6	How to [money goal] on a \$[amount] paycheck.
7	Don't open a [account type] until you watch this.
8	[Number] side hustles you can start with \$0 this weekend.
9	The 50/30/20 rule, explained in 30 seconds.
10	What I'd do with my first \$1,000 if I started over.

#	Fitness hooks
11	Do this before every workout if your [body part] hurts.
12	3 exercises that are wasting your time at the gym.
13	I did [exercise] every day for 30 days. Here's what changed.
14	The easiest high-protein breakfast you can make in 5 minutes.
15	You're doing [exercise] wrong. Here's the fix.
16	No gym? Here's a 10-minute [goal] workout.
17	What [amount] grams of protein actually looks like on a plate.
18	Stop stretching like this before you run.
19	Beginner mistake number one at the gym.
20	If you only have 20 minutes, do this.

#	Cooking hooks
21	A \$[amount] dinner that feeds [number].
22	Stop throwing out [ingredient]. Do this instead.
23	3 ingredients, 10 minutes, almost no dishes.
24	The restaurant trick for [dish] nobody tells you.
25	What I meal prep for a week on \$[amount].
26	You've been cutting [food] wrong.
27	The air fryer recipe I make every single week.
28	Turn leftover [food] into [new dish].
29	One-pan [dish] for nights you can't be bothered.
30	Rate this \$[amount] grocery haul.

#	Tech hooks
31	Your phone can do this and you didn't know.
32	[Number] free apps that replace ones you pay for.
33	Turn this setting off right now.
34	The [app] shortcut that saves me an hour a week.
35	Stop paying for [software]. Use this free one.
36	How to [task] in 10 seconds.
37	I asked AI to [task]. Here's what happened.
38	3 browser extensions I use every single day.
39	Your [device] battery dies fast because of this.
40	Hidden [iPhone/Android] feature: [feature].

#	Motivation hooks
41	Nobody's coming to save you. Here's what to do instead.
42	Read this if you feel behind in life.
43	The 2-minute rule that ended my procrastination.
44	What I'd tell my 20-year-old self.
45	Discipline isn't what you think it is.
46	If you're starting over at [age], watch this.
47	One habit that changed my mornings.
48	Stop waiting to feel ready.
49	3 signs you're closer than you think.
50	Do this when you don't feel like doing anything.

#	Local hooks
51	[Number] spots in [city] locals keep to themselves.
52	Best [food] in [city] under \$[amount].
53	Things to do in [city] this weekend.
54	I tried every [food] spot on [street]. Here's the winner.
55	Free things to do in [city].
56	Moving to [city]? Watch this first.
57	The most underrated [place] in [city].
58	[City] date night ideas under \$[amount].
59	What \$[amount] gets you at [local place].
60	Rating [city]'s [food] spots out of 10.

The free-tools workflow: CapCut and Canva

Target: about 30 minutes per video, less once you've made ten. Both apps have free plans; menu names change between versions, so look for the closest match.

Step 1. Script (5 min)

- Pick today's idea from the calendar and a hook from the hook bank.
- Write 4 to 6 short lines. One idea per line. Read it aloud: aim for 20 to 40 seconds.
- End with one call to action: follow, save, or comment a word.

Step 2. Gather footage (5 min)

- Screen-record, film your hands, or pull free clips from Pexels or Pixabay (check each site's license).
- Film vertical, in good daylight, with your phone lens wiped clean.
- Grab two or three more clips than you think you need.

Step 3. Edit in CapCut (10 min)

- Start a new project and drop clips in order. Trim every pause and "um".
- Record a voiceover in the app or add text lines one at a time.
- Add auto captions (look for Captions or Text, then Auto captions). Check spelling; auto captions get names wrong.
- Keep each shot between 1 and 3 seconds. A cut every couple of seconds keeps attention.
- Use music from the app's own library, or the platform's sound library when you post, so you stay within licensing.

Step 4. Design in Canva (5 min, optional)

- Make a 1080 x 1920 design for a title card, list graphics or a cover frame.
- Save one branded template (fonts, colors, logo spot) and duplicate it for every video.
- Download as MP4 or PNG and drop it into CapCut.

Step 5. Export and post (5 min)

- Export at 1080 x 1920 (9:16), 30 fps. Higher frame rates make bigger files for little gain.
- Write a title or caption that repeats the hook in plain words, plus 2 or 3 relevant hashtags.
- Upload the same video natively to YouTube Shorts, TikTok, Instagram Reels and Facebook Reels. Export from CapCut without a watermark where the app allows it, since some platforms limit reach for reposted, watermarked clips.

Safe zones. Each app covers parts of the screen with buttons and captions. Keep important text inside the middle of the frame: stay out of roughly the top 10%, the bottom 20% and the right-hand 15%. Before posting, preview the video in the app and check that nothing is hidden behind the like button or caption.

PART 6

Batch day: a week of videos in one afternoon

Making one video a day from scratch is how most people quit. Make seven at once, then post one a day.

Done	Step
	Pick 7 ideas from the calendar and assign a hook to each.
	Write all 7 scripts in one sitting (about 35 minutes).
	Film or record all footage in one session. Change your shirt or background between videos if your hands are on camera.
	Edit all 7 in CapCut with the same caption style and template.
	Name files Day01, Day02 and so on so you never post one twice.
	Schedule them, or set a daily phone alarm to post at the same time each day.
	Rough time: one afternoon of 3 to 4 hours for a whole week of videos.

This week's 7 videos

Day	Idea	Format	Hook #	Posted
1				
2				
3				
4				
5				
6				
7				

PART 7

The 30-day calendar

Replace [niche] with your topic. Days 7, 14, 21 and 28 are review days: no new idea, just improve what worked.

Day	Format	Video idea	Hook tip	Done
1	List	3 mistakes beginners make in [niche]	Use a "Stop doing" hook	
2	Text-story	The moment I realized [lesson about niche]	Tension in line one	
3	Tutorial	How to [basic task] in under 60 seconds	"How to [task] in X seconds"	
4	Voiceover	Why [common belief in niche] is wrong	Bold claim first	
5	Hands-only	Watch me [simple task] start to finish	Show the result first	
6	List	5 tools I use every week for [niche]	Number + payoff	
7	Review	Weekly review. Repost your best video with a new hook	Swap the first line only	
8	Tutorial	The [tool] setting most people never change	"Turn this on/off right now"	
9	Voiceover	[Niche term] explained in 30 seconds	"Explained in 30 seconds"	
10	List	3 things nobody tells you about [niche]	"Nobody tells you"	
11	Hands-only	Before and after: [result]	Show the after first	
12	Text-story	I tried [niche thing] for 7 days. Here's what happened	"I tried X"	
13	List	[Number] cheap or free alternatives to [expensive thing]	Price in the hook	
14	Review	Weekly review. Make a part 2 of your top video	"Part 2" in the hook	
15	Tutorial	Beginner's first step in [niche]	"If you're starting at zero"	
16	Voiceover	The biggest myth in [niche]	"Stop believing"	
17	Hands-only	My [niche] setup / routine	"What my X looks like"	
18	List	Rate these [niche items] out of 10	Ask viewers to disagree	
19	Text-story	A comment that changed how I think about [niche]	Quote the comment	
20	Tutorial	Fix this common [niche] problem in 3 steps	"You're doing X wrong"	
21	Review	Weekly review. Answer your best comment in a video	Show the comment on screen	
22	List	What I'd do if I started [niche] again	"If I started over"	
23	Voiceover	[Number] numbers every [niche] beginner should know	Specific number	

Day	Format	Video idea	Hook tip	Done
24	Hands-only	Satisfying [niche] process, sped up	No talking, strong first frame	
25	Tutorial	The fastest way to [task]	"In 10 seconds"	
26	Text-story	My biggest [niche] mistake (and what it cost)	Cost in line one	
27	List	[Niche] products worth the money vs. not	"Worth it or not"	
28	Review	Weekly review. Remake your weakest video with a new hook	Change the first 2 seconds	
29	Voiceover	Answer: the most common question in [niche]	Ask the question as the hook	
30	List	What I learned posting 30 days in a row	"30 days" in the hook	

Monetization map

Platforms change their payout rules often, so this map points you to the official source instead of quoting numbers that go out of date. Check each one before you plan around it.

Option	How it pays	Where to check
YouTube Partner Program	Pays a share of ad revenue, including from Shorts, once your channel meets the subscriber and view requirements and is approved. The thresholds change, so check the current ones.	support.google.com/youtube/answer/72851
TikTok Creator Rewards Program	Pays for qualifying videos, which have generally needed to be longer than one minute, once your account meets follower, view and age requirements. Rules and regions change often.	TikTok Help Center: search "Creator Rewards Program"
Facebook and Instagram	Meta runs content monetization programs for Reels that change often and are invite-only in some regions.	Professional Dashboard > Monetization in the Facebook or Instagram app
Affiliate links	You earn a commission when viewers buy through your link. This can work from your first video, before you qualify for any platform program. Options include Amazon Associates and the affiliate programs most apps and tools run.	affiliate-program.amazon.com
Disclose every paid link	In the US the FTC requires a clear disclosure when you earn from a link or were paid or gifted a product. Say it in the video or put it at the top of the caption, for example "#ad" or "I earn from this link".	ftc.gov/business-guidance/resources/disclosures-101-social-media-influencers
Your own product	Once people ask the same questions in your comments, package the answers into a checklist, template or guide and link it in your bio. This is often the highest-margin option.	Gumroad, Payhip, Stan or Shopify

Realistic order for a new channel: affiliate links you'd recommend anyway, then your own small product, then platform payouts once you qualify.

PART 9

The 5-minute weekly review

Every 7th day, open your analytics and fill this in. Print one copy per week.

Video	Views	Avg % viewed	Likes	Saves/shares	New followers

Which video had the highest average view duration or percentage viewed? Why do I think it worked?

Which video had the lowest? Was it the hook, the topic or the pacing?

Which format performed best this week?

What did people ask or argue about in the comments?

Repeat: one thing I'll do again next week.

Drop: one thing I'll stop doing.

Test: one new hook or format I'll try.

Final rules

- Post for 30 days before judging the results. Early numbers swing a lot.
- Change one thing at a time so you know what made the difference.
- Your first 10 videos teach you to make videos. Your next 20 teach you what your audience wants.
- Never buy views, followers or engagement. It breaks platform rules and wrecks your reach.

Day 1 starts now: score your niche, write 10 ideas, and batch your first 7 videos this week.

Disclaimer: this guide is for education only. No income or results are promised. Platform names and features belong to their owners; this guide is not affiliated with or endorsed by YouTube, TikTok, Meta, CapCut, Canva or any other company named.